

GameCube – Swiss Guide + SD2SP2 / SD Gecko / Action Replay

Step-by-step guide, very easy to follow, to load games from an SD card on GameCube without complications.

Recommended links

-  Swiss – Official releases:
[Download Swiss \(Official GitHub\)](#)

Here you will always find the latest stable version of Swiss. It is the “brain” that manages everything.

-  Recommended creator – Retro Game Corps:
[GameCube + Swiss Guides – Retro Game Corps](#)

Very clear videos to see the process on screen if you get lost at any step.

Recommended material

These links may contain affiliate tags. You only need to replace the affiliate ID in each URL.

 SD2SP2 Adapter (Amazon)

 SD2SP2 (AliExpress)

 SD Gecko (Memory Card slot)

 Action Replay / SD Media Launcher

 MicroSD 128GB (Amazon)

 PicoBoot Kit (soldering mod)

LEGAL NOTICE:

This guide is intended for using backups of games you already own physically or free software. It does not support or explain how to download games illegally. Swiss is a Homebrew tool to manage legal backups and improve your GameCube experience.

What is Swiss and what are SD2SP2 / SD Gecko?

Swiss is a special program that runs on the GameCube and allows you to:

- Load games from an SD card instead of using discs.
- Force video modes (e.g., 480p) for better image quality.
- Use virtual Memory Cards stored on the SD.

For Swiss to read games from an SD card, you need an adapter:

- **SD2SP2**: plugs into Serial Port 2 under the console.
- **SD Gecko**: plugs into a front Memory Card slot.

Think of Swiss as the “advanced menu” and SD2SP2 / SD Gecko as the GameCube’s “SD card reader”.

Console compatibility

-  **GameCube DOL-001** – Has Serial Port 2 under the console. Compatible with SD2SP2.
-  **GameCube DOL-101** – No visible Serial Port 2. You can:
 - Use an **SD Gecko** in a Memory Card slot.
 - Or do advanced soldering mods (not recommended for beginners).

The console model appears on the bottom sticker (DOL-001 or DOL-101).

Required material (minimum)

- A working **GameCube**.
- A **MicroSD card** (32–128GB recommended).
- An **SD2SP2** or **SD Gecko** adapter.
- A method to boot Swiss:
 - **PicoBoot** (requires soldering, most “pro” option).
 - **Action Replay / SD Media Launcher** (no soldering, uses a disc).
 - Other advanced methods (GC Loader, etc.).
- A **PC** to copy files to the MicroSD.

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Prepare the MicroSD card

We will prepare the MicroSD so Swiss works on the first try.

1. Connect the MicroSD to the PC (use a USB reader if needed).
2. Format the MicroSD:
 - Use **FAT32** for maximum compatibility.
 - Modern Swiss versions also support **exFAT**, but FAT32 is safest.Windows: right-click the card → "Format..." → File system: FAT32 → Start.
3. Download the latest Swiss release from GitHub. Inside the ZIP, find the `dol` folder and locate a file like: `swiss_rXXXX.dol`.
4. Copy `swiss_rXXXX.dol` to the root of the MicroSD. If using PicoBoot, rename it to `ip1.dol` (explained later).
5. Create a folder named `GAMES` in the root of the MicroSD. Place your personal backups in `.iso` or `.gcm` format inside it.

```
Typical MicroSD contents:
```

```
-----
```

```
/GAMES/
```

```
swiss_rXXXX.dol
```

```
GAMES/Resident_Evil_4.iso
```

```
GAMES/F-Zero_GX.gcm
```

If your card looks like this, the basic setup is correct.

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Methods to boot Swiss

There are two main simple methods:

- 🔧 **Method A – PicoBoot** (requires soldering, always boots Swiss).
- 🎮 **Method B – Action Replay / SD Media Launcher + SD Gecko** (no soldering, uses a disc).

Method A – PicoBoot (very simple summary)

This method is for those who can solder or take the console to someone who can. Once installed, the GameCube boots Swiss automatically from the MicroSD.

1. Install the PicoBoot mod on the GameCube motherboard (soldering required).

2. Rename the Swiss file to `ip1.dol`.
3. Copy `ip1.dol` to the root of the MicroSD.
4. Insert the MicroSD into the SD2SP2 and place the SD2SP2 in Serial Port 2.
5. Turn on the console: Swiss should boot automatically.

Method B – Action Replay / SD Media Launcher (no soldering)

This method is more beginner-friendly: it uses a special disc that loads Swiss from an SD card in an SD Gecko.

1. Buy an **Action Replay** or **SD Media Launcher** compatible with GameCube.
2. Insert an SD card (or MicroSD with adapter) into the **SD Gecko**.
3. Copy `swiss_rXXXX.dol` to the SD in the SD Gecko (e.g., in the root).
4. Insert the SD Gecko into a Memory Card slot (usually Slot B).
5. Insert the Action Replay / SD Media Launcher disc into the GameCube.
6. Turn on the console and navigate the disc menu to load a DOL file from SD.
7. Select the Swiss file. If everything is correct, the Swiss menu will appear.

Once inside Swiss, even if you loaded it from SD Gecko, you can still use SD2SP2 as the main device for games (faster and doesn't occupy front slots).

3 Using Swiss to load games

When Swiss loads correctly, you will see a menu with devices and folders.

1. Ensure the SD2SP2 is properly inserted in Serial Port 2 (text facing outward).
2. In Swiss, use the D-pad to navigate.
3. Press **B** to switch devices until you select **SD2SP2** or **SD Gecko**.
4. Enter the `GAMES` folder.
5. Select a game and press **A** to open its options.
6. Press **A** again to launch it with default settings.

```
SWISS v0.6 - Main Menu
-----
Device: SD2SP2 (Serial Port 2)

> [DIR] GAMES
- F-Zero_GX.iso
- Resident_Evil_4.gcm

[A] Open [B] Change Device [X] Options
```

If you see something like this, Swiss is reading your SD card and games correctly.

4 Improve image quality – Force 480p

One of Swiss's biggest advantages is that it can make many games look better than on the original console.

- Before launching a game, select it and press **X** to open advanced options.
- Look for the **Video Mode** option.
- Select **Force 480p** if you are using component cables or a compatible HDMI adapter.
- Save the changes and launch the game with **A**.

```
Game Settings - F-Zero GX
-----
Video Mode: Force 480p (On)
Widescreen Hack: Off
In-Game Reset: Enabled

[A] Start Game [B] Back
```

If your TV or capture card supports it, you will notice a much sharper image compared to 480i.

Common errors and how to fix them

Error: "SD Card not detected" or SD2SP2 not showing:

- Check that the SD2SP2 is properly inserted: the text on the board must face outward.
- Turn off the console, remove and reinsert the adapter carefully.
- Make sure the MicroSD is fully inserted into the SD2SP2.
- Try formatting the MicroSD again in FAT32 and recopying the files.

Swiss loads, but I don't see my games:

- Check that the games are inside the GAMES folder.
- Make sure the files are .iso or .gcm.
- Avoid strange characters in filenames; use letters, numbers, and underscores.

Action Replay / SD Media Launcher disc won't load:

- Check that the disc is not scratched.
- Try cleaning the GameCube lens with a proper cleaning kit.
- If the drive is very worn out, consider a method like PicoBoot or GC Loader.

Optimization and savings

- **Virtual Memory Card:** Swiss allows saving game data directly on the SD, simulating a Memory Card. No need to buy multiple physical cards.
- **NKIT format:** Some backups in .nkit.iso format take up less space. Use them only if you know they are compatible with Swiss.
- **One SD for everything:** You can store multiple games, homebrew, and configurations on the same card, well organized in folders.
- **Be careful with shutdowns:** Do not turn off the console while Swiss is saving or reading for a long time to avoid data corruption.